BRAND MANUAL
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Brand guidelines for a software architecture and consulting practice. Architectural clarity for software decisions.

CLARITY BEFORE COMPLEXITY SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & CONSULTING

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01 — FOUNDATION

Brand foundation

Better software begins with better decisions. This brand exists to bring architectural clarity to the software choices that shape a business — diagnosing first, making tradeoffs explicit, and tying every recommendation to its business consequence.

BRAND IDEA

Architectural clarity for software decisions

BRAND PROMISE

Clarity before Complexity.

Positioning

Senior software architecture, consulting, modernization, integration and fractional technical leadership. The practice is personal, not an agency: one senior architect who diagnoses before prescribing and explains consequences rather than impressing with jargon.

Audience

Founders, business owners and engineering leaders — in Chile and with international remote clients — who need a senior technical perspective on decisions with real cost, risk and timeline implications.

Service families

01

Software Architecture & Advisory

Diagnosis, architectural decisions and roadmaps.

02

Product & Business Consulting

Bridging engineering execution and market reality.

03

Modernization & Integration

Systematic refactoring of legacy systems and the connections between them.

04

Fractional Software Architect

Part-time senior architectural leadership, embedded in the client's team.

02 — IDENTITY

Logo

The logo pairs a line-drawn symbol — concentric arcs around an interface core — with the wordmark “Brian Stefanovich” set in Montserrat 700. The symbol is always monochrome. The wordmark is live type, never redrawn or outlined by hand.



Figure 1. Principal lockup on Carbon (dark) and Porcelain (light).

Five lockups

Each lockup exists in a light and a dark version. Choose by available space, from most to least complete.

LOCKUP	COMPOSITION	USE WHEN
Principal	Symbol + name + descriptor, horizontal	Default. Website header, proposals, decks.
Simplificado	Symbol + name	The descriptor would fall below legible size.
Vertical	Symbol stacked above name	Square or portrait formats, covers.
Mini	Symbol only, in a square frame	Avatars, favicons, app icons.
Independiente	Symbol only, no frame	Watermarks, signatures, once the name is already present.

Usage rules

DO

- Use Porcelain on Carbon, or Carbon on Porcelain.
- Keep clear space of at least the symbol's inner-circle diameter.
- Pair the symbol with the name at least once per piece.

DON'T

- Colour the symbol in Blueprint, Copper or gradients.
- Stretch, rotate, outline or add effects.
- Set the wordmark in any font other than Montserrat 700.

03 — COLOR

Color system

A near-monochrome architectural base carries every composition. Two signature accents are used asymmetrically: Blueprint for function and action, Copper for the human side and for consequence. Copper never gets equal weight to Blueprint.

Core neutrals

Carbon
#101311
carbon-950

Graphite
#2A2F2C
graphite-800

Steel
#717A75
steel-500

Fog
#D8DED9
fog-150

Porcelain
#F4F0E8
porcelain-050

Signature accents

Blueprint

#465CD4 · on dark #91A0FF

Functional. Buttons, links, active states, heading bars, bullets, phase numbers.

Copper

#A65330 · on dark #D88755

Human and consequence. A single highlighted word, a business outcome, a warning about risk.

Proportion rule

Every composition should approximate this mix. On a dark page Carbon leads; on a light page Porcelain leads and Carbon takes the 30%.



60% CARBON 30% PORCELAIN 8%

Figure 2. 60 base / 30 inverse neutral / 8 Blueprint / 2 Copper.

Semantic tokens

ROLE	TOKEN	VALUE
Page background	`--surface-page`	Carbon (inverse: Porcelain)
Card	`--surface-card`	Graphite #2A2F2C
Elevated card	`--surface-card-elevated`	Graphite #2E3733
Primary text	`--text-primary`	Porcelain (inverse: Carbon)
Secondary text	`--text-secondary`	Steel #717A75
Link	`--text-link`	Blueprint (on dark: #91A0FF)
Hairline border	`--border-hairline`	Fog #D8DED9
Error	`--danger-500`	#BA1A1A, system states only

04 — TYPOGRAPHY

Typography

Three typefaces, each with a single job. Never swap roles: Montserrat never sets paragraphs, JetBrains Mono never sets sentences.

DISPLAY

Montserrat 700
Headings only

Better software begins with better decisions.

BODY

Open Sans 400
Paragraphs, UI text

I diagnose the system before recommending a change. Every option comes with its tradeoffs and what it means for cost, risk and timeline.

TECHNICAL

JetBrains Mono 500
Labels, eyebrows, nav

PHASE 03 · MODERNIZATION
RIGOROUS & INTENTIONAL

Type scale

STYLE	FONT	SIZE / LEADING	TRACKING
Headline XL	Montserrat 700	54 / 59.4	-1.08px
H2	Montserrat 700	40 / 48	0
Headline MD	Montserrat 700	34 / 40.8	-0.85px
H3 / card title	Montserrat 700	27 / 35.1	0
Body lead	Open Sans 400	23 / 36.8	0
Body	Open Sans 400	18 / 28.8	0
LABEL	JetBrains Mono 500	18 / 25.2	+0.9px
EYEBROW	JetBrains Mono 500	14 / 19.6	+0.7 / +1.4px

Rules

- Headings use Montserrat 700 only. Never 800 or 900.
- Sentence case for headlines and body copy.
- Uppercase with wide tracking is reserved for JetBrains Mono labels — eyebrows, nav links, footer attributes, phase numbers.

05 — STRUCTURE

Layout, grid & motifs

The schematic frame

The signature motif. Every section is framed by a hairline: 1px Fog on top, right and left, 2px Fog on the bottom — like a technical drawing sheet. It appears on the hero, every content section, the top nav and the footer.

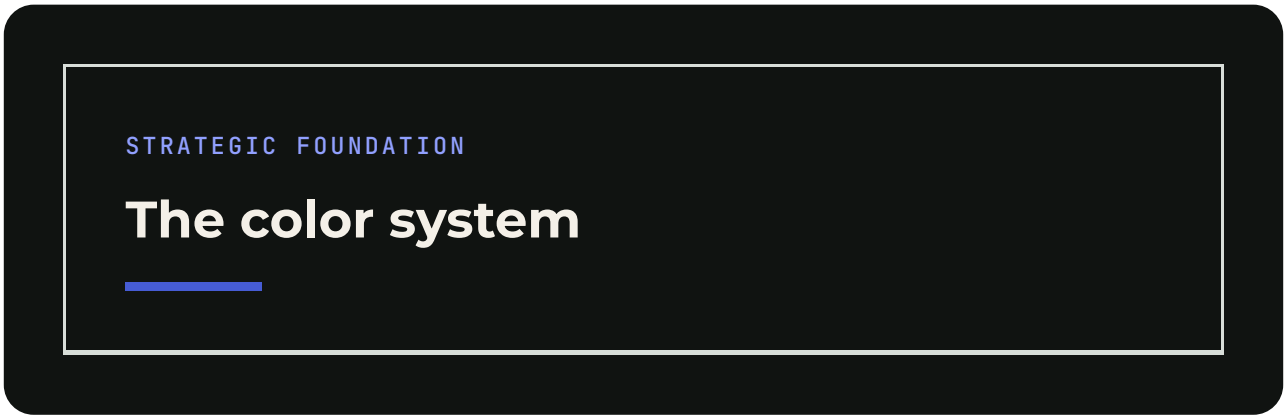


Figure 3. Section frame with eyebrow, H2 and 64×4px Blueprint bar.

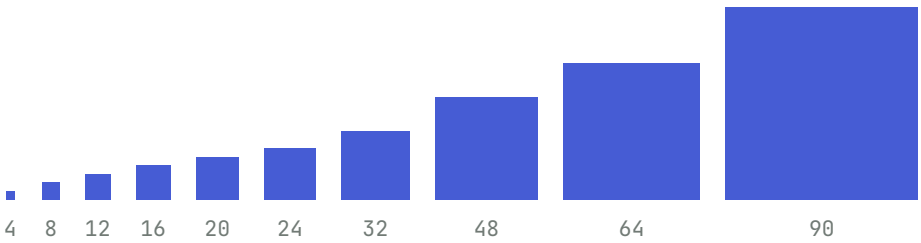
Grid

- 12 columns, 32px gutters
- 90px page margins (desktop)
- 45px vertical section padding

Corner radii

- 8px — small elements, swatches
- 14px — default for cards and buttons
- 18px — the single hero / offer card
- 9999px — pills and circular buttons

Spacing scale — 8px base



Surfaces, borders & motion

- No drop shadows. Cards are separated by an inset 1px Fog hairline (2px for the light, elevated card).

- Dividers are 1px Fog, full width inside cards; a thin 1px rule sits under an H2 subtitle line.
- Motion is calm and purposeful: 200–450ms transitions, 300ms ease by default. No continuous spinning or looping decoration.

06 — COMPONENTS

Components

A small set of primitives, all derived from the brand page. Reuse them before creating anything new.

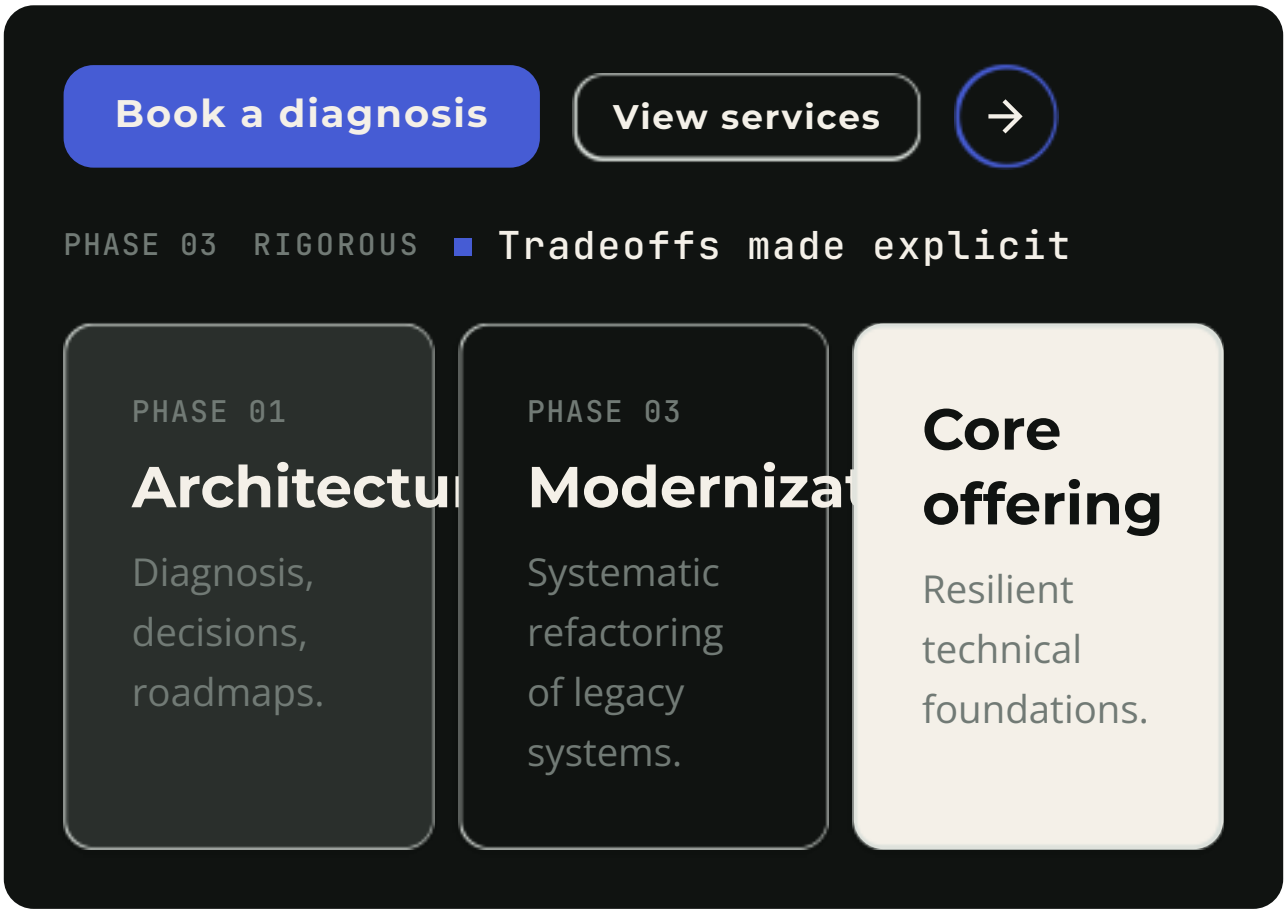


Figure 4. Button, outline button, icon button, tags, list item and the three card tones.

COMPONENT	SPECIFICATION
Button	Radius 14, Blueprint fill, Porcelain Montserrat 700 text. Hover: subtle brightness lift. Tones: primary, secondary, outline.
Icon button	48px circle, 2px Blueprint ring, arrow glyph. No fill.
Card	Radius 14, inset Fog hairline, no shadow. Tones: graphite, elevated, carbon, porcelain.
Section heading	Mono eyebrow, H2, 64×4px Blueprint bar.
Tag	Uppercase JetBrains Mono label for eyebrows and attributes.
List item	8×8px Blueprint square bullet with a mono label.
Nav bar & footer	Wordmark plus underlined mono links; footer adds a brand-attribute row and copyright, inside the schematic frame.

07 — VISUAL LANGUAGE

Iconography & imagery



Figure 5. The three brand line icons. They inherit Blueprint, Copper or Porcelain from context.

Icons

- Simple geometric line icons with a consistent stroke, circular terminals and restrained corner radii.
- Single colour, inherited from context. No filled, cartoon or 3D icons; no emoji or unicode symbols as icons.

Photography

Documentary and warm-lit: real people, real working sessions, real places. Photography should feel like evidence, not decoration.

NEVER USE

- Floating code, neon circuitry or glowing network graphics.
- Synthetic “AI” imagery or generic stock of people pointing at screens.
- Aggressive gradients behind content.

08 — VOICE

Voice & tone

Calm, senior, specific. The voice explains consequences instead of impressing with jargon. It sounds like an experienced architect talking to a founder across a table.

01

First person, singular

“I diagnose,” “my recommendation.” A personal practice, never an agency “we.”

02

Consequence first

Tie every technical point to its effect on cost, risk, time or growth.

03

Tradeoffs out loud

Name what each option costs. Never promise certainty that doesn't exist.

Vocabulary

FAVOR

clarity decision architecture system constraint risk tradeoff evolution roadmap evidence maintainability outcome

AVOID

~~disruption~~ ~~cutting-edge~~ ~~world-class~~ ~~360°~~ ~~digital transformation~~ ~~scalable solution~~ ~~synergy~~ ~~magic~~ ~~guaranteed~~ ~~future-proof~~

In practice

INSTEAD OF	WRITE
We deliver cutting-edge, future-proof solutions.	I help you choose an architecture you can still change in three years.
End-to-end digital transformation.	Systematic refactoring of legacy systems, one constraint at a time.
Guaranteed scalability.	Here is where the system will strain first, and what it costs to address now versus later.

Writing rules

- Sentence case everywhere except JetBrains Mono labels.
- No emoji.
- Short sentences. One idea each. Concrete nouns over abstractions.
- Spanish copy uses natural Latin American Spanish with minimal Spanglish. Explain “fractional” on first use — for example, “arquitecto de software fraccional: liderazgo técnico senior a tiempo parcial.”